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SS
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# Paid search that pays back.

I run Google and Microsoft Ads for 20+ e-commerce and lead-gen accounts. I fix measurement first, then rebuild accounts around real purchase data and non-brand demand.

**Case studies**
Four accounts, before and after

**Audits**
What I look for in a new account

**Ad copy**
Headlines I wrote and why

**How I diagnose a drop**
The order I check things in

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**~$1.5M**
Google Ads spend, last 12 months

**$160K**
peak month across my accounts

**$83K**
peak month, largest account

**20+**
accounts, D2C and lead gen

## CASE STUDIES

CLIENT NAMES WITHHELD

PRECIOUS-METALS DEALER · $6.9K AVERAGE ORDER

# −78%

cost per online purchase, $151 → $34

## Bidding on the conversion that pays

The account bid for calls and store directions. Smart Bidding was chasing cheap, low-intent actions and never learning who actually buys online.

I made the online purchase the only conversion the account bids for, and kept calls and directions as observation-only actions.

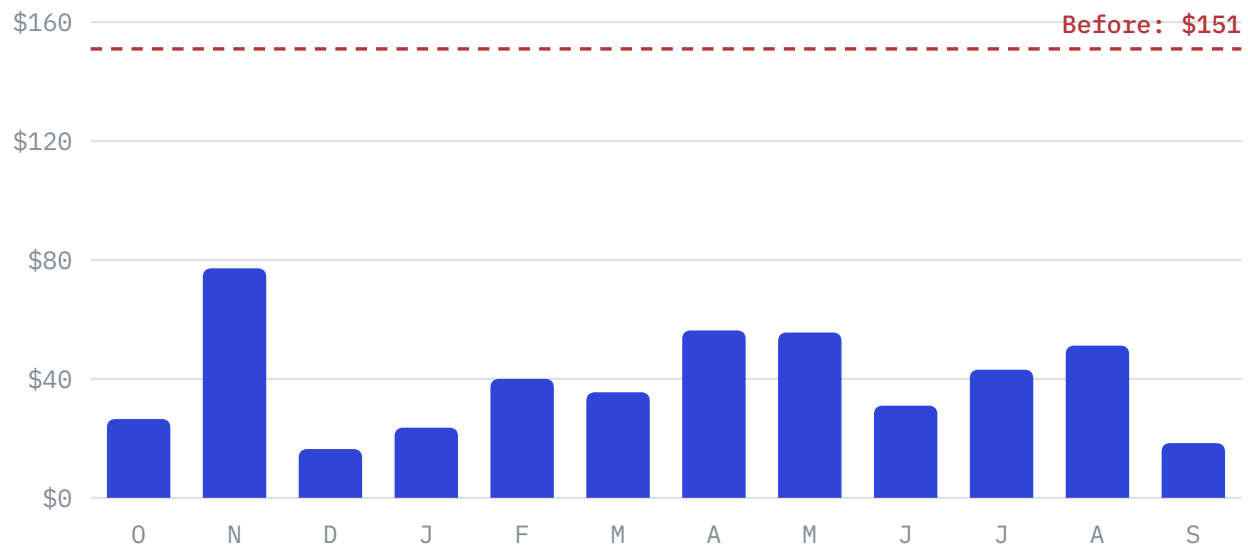
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**WHAT I LEARNED** I check which conversion action bidding is optimising for before touching budgets or bids on any new account.

Google Ads API · GA4 purchase action · Oct 2025 – Sep 2026 vs Nov 2024 – Feb 2025

### Cost per online purchase, by month

Every month under me came in below the old $151 average



HOME-HARDWARE D2C · ~$720K A YEAR

# 3.31 → 3.60

ROAS in my first 12 months vs the 12 before, on 13% less spend

## More return on less spend

- Made non-brand Performance Max the main engine, growing it from $7.7K to $31.6K a month.
- Added a high-AOV Performance Max, a tighter brand campaign, best-seller Shopping and Demand Gen.
- Retired the old general-brand and manual Shopping campaigns.

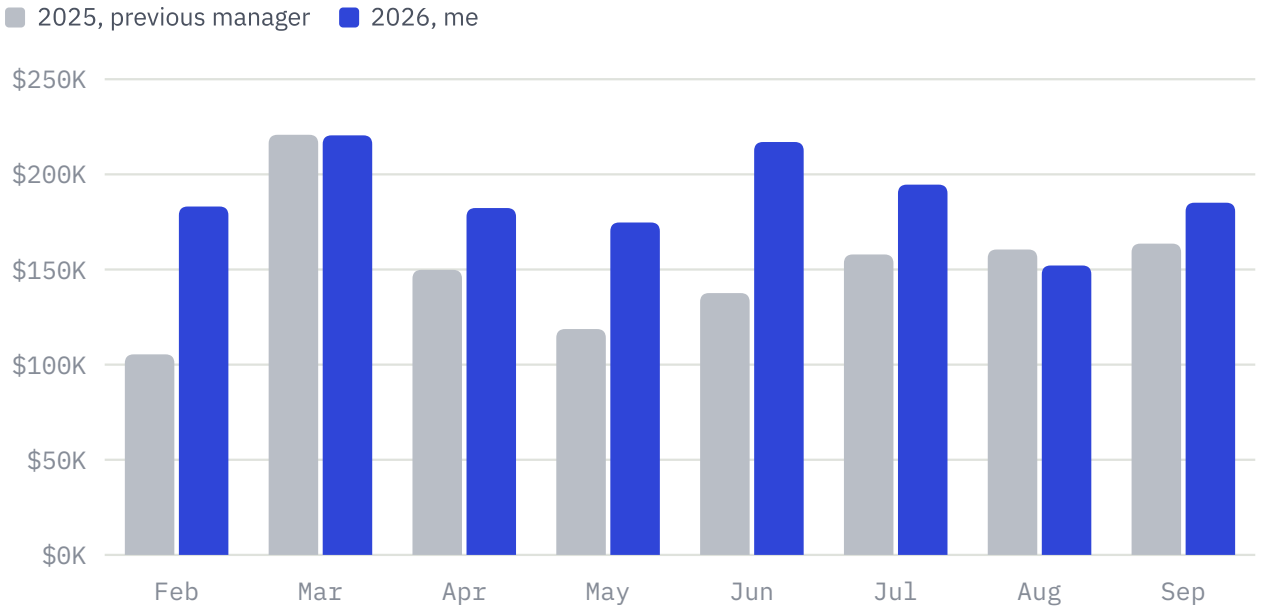
| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **-8.5%**<br>cost per conversion | **2.98 → 3.41**<br>holiday-quarter ROAS, a third less spend | **-23%**<br>cost per order, Aug–Sep YoY |

WHAT I LEARNED A Walmart Demand Gen campaign showed zero conversions in Google Ads, but ThoughtMetric credited it with $32.5K in sales in a month. I judge top-of-funnel on assisted sales.

Google Ads API · ThoughtMetric · took over Oct 2025

### Google Ads sales by month, ThoughtMetric

Feb–Sep: +24% sales on +15% spend, year on year



D2C EYEWEAR · ~$40K A MONTH

# 13 → 5

spending campaigns, on flat year-on-year spend

## Consolidation and clean tracking

- Cut lines returning under 1.5 ROAS: dynamic search, old Shopping, non-brand Search.
- Rebuilt Shopping around 15 products; it grew from $200 to $11.6K a month.
- Merged four overlapping purchase tags into one. They had recorded $11.6M of conversion value in a single month on $38K of spend.

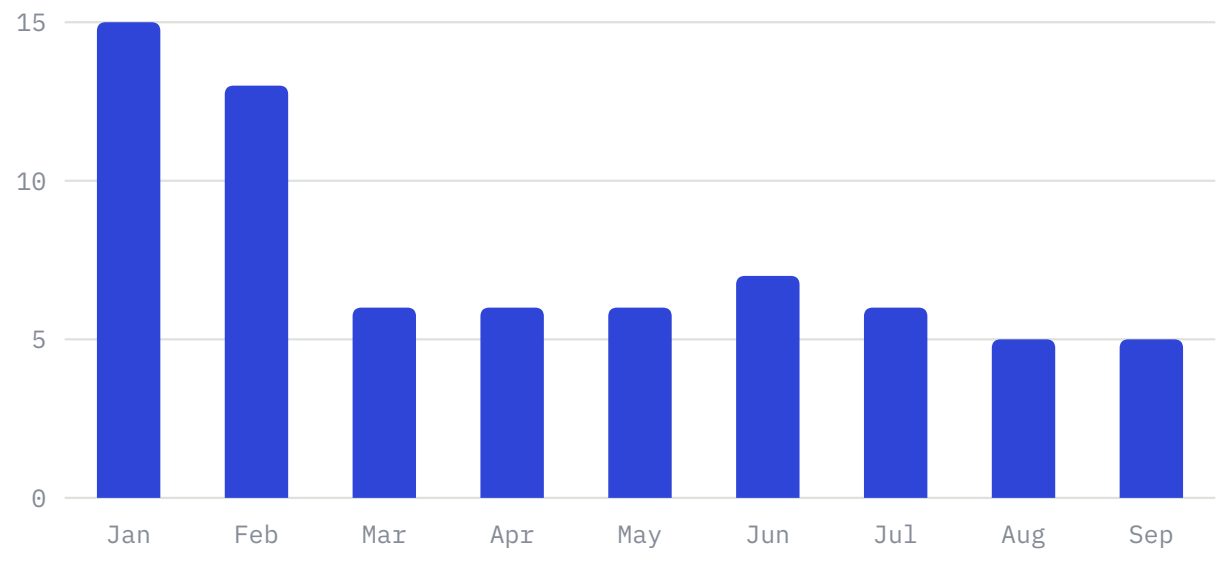
| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **+36%** Google sales Q1 → Q3, on +30% spend (Shopify) | **+10%** order value, $64.73 → $71.22 | **-14%** spend to match Q4 2025's sales in Q3 |

**WHAT I LEARNED** Later the purchase action drifted to about 1.8× what GA4 and Shopify saw, so I report this account on Shopify numbers, not the platform's.

`Google Ads API (structure, spend) · Shopify last non-direct click (sales)`

### Campaigns with spend, by month (2026)

Fewer, larger campaigns give Smart Bidding more data per campaign



RECOVERY-DEVICE BRAND · ~$2K A MONTH

# 4×

non-brand conversions a month, at 6% lower cost

## Building demand beyond the brand name

The account was one brand Shopping campaign at 22× ROAS, but 82% of sales came from people already searching the brand. It wasn't finding new buyers.

I rebuilt it in June 2026 with Performance Max, Shopping and non-brand Search, then mined search terms every month and turned winners into asset groups and feed titles.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **106 / 113**<br>converting non-brand terms new to the account | **1 → 24**<br>converting terms in the travel / jet-lag theme | **109 → 341**<br>Google paid orders, May → June |

Cube monthly reports and non-brand review · account has since churned

### Non-brand conversions per month

Average before the rebuild vs the three months after




Cost per non-brand conversion




**AUDITS** WHAT I FIND IN A NEW ACCOUNT

CHAMPAGNE GIFTING BRAND · JUNE 2026

# 1.66 → 2.76

Performance Max ROAS after the rebuild (Aug–Oct vs Apr–Jul 2026)

## Audit, then rebuild

The account looked healthy at 4× ROAS. Underneath, most of it was switched off or fighting itself. I rebuilt Performance Max around gifting intent, put the hero products back in the feed and removed the category negatives.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **8.0 → 11.0** | **4.87** | **+22%** |
| brand Search ROAS | account ROAS, Aug–Oct 2026 | revenue on +15% spend |

My audit deck · results from the Google Ads API

| | |
|---|---|
| **2 / 25** | campaigns actually spending |
| **89%** | impression share lost to rank on the keyword driving 61% of conversions. The tROAS target was 20×; it delivered 7–8×. |
| **3×** | higher brand CPC after AI Max was switched on, with no extra conversions |
| **1,552** | Performance Max negatives blocking the brand's own category, like "gifts" and "champagne" |
| **6 / 13** | hero products missing from the feed, while 190 budget products spent $763 for nothing |
| **31%** | of products disapproved after Merchant Center rejected the alcohol authorisation |

DIAMOND-JEWELLERY BRAND · JULY 2026

# 891×

the ROAS the account was reporting

## The ROAS that wasn't

99.97% of its 16,856 "conversions" were add-to-carts. There were zero purchases in 12 months.

`Diagnosis only, no results claimed`

THE REBUILD PLAN I PROPOSED

**01** **Fix tracking**
Purchases only as the primary conversion.

**02** **Non-brand Search by country**
Manual CPC while there's no purchase data to learn from.

**03** **Shopping**
Once the feed and tracking are clean.

**04** **Performance Max**
Only after 30+ real purchases.

**AD COPY** BRAND NAMES REMOVED

## Headline refresh for a UK healthcare retailer

Performance Max asset group · Aug 2026

Four headlines used "Medical" or "Rehab", which triggers Google's health restriction on personalised ads and had switched off remarketing and Customer Match. The rest were generic. I replaced them with the categories that actually converted in Q4 search terms.

| | |
|---|---|
| – ~~Top Medical Supplies and Rehab~~ | ~~policy~~ |
| – ~~Leading UK Medical Supplier~~ | ~~policy~~ |
| + Commodes & Toilet Aids | 18 conv. in Q4 |
| + Cushions & Bed Pads | 16+ conv. |
| + Insoles for Knee & Joint Pain | search theme |

## Preorder launch for a leather phone-case brand

Performance Max assets · Sep 2026

Buyers were early adopters looking for a case before most brands had one, so the copy leads with the exact device, the ship date and what sets it apart.

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Leather Case for iPhone Duo | Preorder Now, Ships Oct 16

Not another plastic case. Real leather craftsmanship for Apple's new foldable phone. Detachable inner case for slim or full carry.

| | |
|---|---|
| + Not Another Plastic Case | 24/30 |
| + Detachable Wallet Folio | 23/30 |
| + 3-Year Warranty Included | 24/30 |

### HOW I DIAGNOSE A ROAS DROP

IN THIS ORDER

**01** **Impression share**

Are we losing auctions to rank or to budget? The fixes are different.

**02** **Bidding**

Is the tROAS target realistic for what the campaign delivers, or is it throttling volume?

**03** **Channel mix**

On Performance Max, is spend drifting into Display, Gmail or Discover placements?

**04** **Products**

Best sellers out of stock, Merchant Center disapprovals, feed issues.

**05** **Tracking**

Compare Google Ads with Shopify and GA4. A broken tag looks exactly like a ROAS crash.

**Only then do I change bids or budgets.**

## TOOLS AND BACKGROUND

### Google Ads Transparency Scraper

Apify Store · Python, Selenium, Tesseract OCR

Checks whether any domain runs Google Ads, pulls its image and video creatives and reads the ad copy with OCR. 46 users, 21K+ runs.

### Client report automation

GAQL · MCP

Weekly and monthly Google Ads client reports generated straight from live account data.

| | |
|---|---|
| Performance Marketing Analyst, Cubehq.ai | Oct 2025 – now |
| SEO Lead, Cubehq.ai | Sep – Dec 2025 |
| SEO Analyst, Cubehq.ai | May – Aug 2025 |
| Founder's Office, Cubehq.ai | Feb – Apr 2025 |
| B.Tech, PES University | 2019 – 2023 |

Google Ads: Search, Shopping, Performance Max, Demand Gen, YouTube · Microsoft Ads · Merchant Center · GA4 · ThoughtMetric · Shopify · Looker Studio · GAQL · Clarity · Python · Meta Ads (recent)

# Hiring for paid search?

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